



PUBLIC & CHARITABLE SECTOR GAPS

80

► Dedicated cancer hospitals

62

► Regional Cancer Centres under National Cancer Control Programme

19

► Proposed State Cancer Institutes

20

► Proposed Tertiary Care Centres

SOURCE MINISTRY OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE

sustaining innovation while ensuring affordability. Pharma giant Sun Pharma's annual report says oncology and immunology continue to lead growth. There has been continued expansion in advanced therapy areas, particularly oncology. Notably, areas such as oncology, immunology, diabetes, and obesity are expected to see significant advances, supported by a robust wave of next-generation biotherapeutics. Oncology will remain the dominant therapy area, accounting for nearly one-third of new products.

DETECTING EARLY

With the rise in the number of cancer cases, diagnostic companies are also stepping up their game. Organised players such as Dr. Lal PathLabs, Metropolis Healthcare

and Agilus Diagnostics are investing in new technologies, expanding lab networks, and strengthening reach beyond metros.

Metropolis Healthcare is focusing on genomic, molecular, and digital testing to bring precision diagnostics to patients outside major cities. In the past year, the company has added more than 60 tests. "With two CAP-accredited referral laboratories and one of India's largest next-generation sequencing portfolios, Metropolis is working to create a centre of excellence in cancer diagnostics," says Managing Director Surendran Chemmenkotil. The acquisition of Core Diagnostics connected it to a network of more than 1,600 oncologists and 6,000 prescribers in over 200 non-metro cities. Pharma partnerships extend

early detection capabilities.

Collaborations such as the launch of India's first self-sampling HPV DNA test with Roche Diagnostics India have brought preventive oncology to women in smaller towns. Digital pathology and AI-driven platforms allow doctors in Tier II and III cities to access specialist expertise remotely, reducing turnaround times in cancer diagnostics by up to 50%. Oncology has become one of the fastest-growing segments for the company, with a 32 per cent increase in revenue in Q1FY26.

Medtech firm Poly Medicure is concentrating on the full spectrum of oncology care from diagnostics and drug delivery to palliative support. Poly Medicure offers medical devices that make long-term treat-